SMB AUTOMATION

SAMPLE DELIVERABLE

Business Efficiency Audit

Prepared for Meridian Property Group

Residential property management | 22 employees | 1,150 units under management

ABOUT THIS SAMPLE

Meridian Property Group is a fictional company. Every number, workflow, and finding in this document is representative of a real audit but has been created for illustration. Your audit follows this exact structure, built from your workflows and your numbers.

Fixed fee: $1,500 | Delivered seven business days after discovery

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SECTION 01

Executive Summary

Meridian Property Group manages 1,150 residential units across 38 properties with a team of 22. Revenue is healthy and occupancy is strong. The operational picture is different: the team absorbs growth by working harder, not by improving the process. Three full-time equivalents of capacity are currently consumed by work that software the company already owns could do.

Discovery covered leasing, maintenance, accounting, and resident services. We documented 14 recurring workflows, interviewed 6 employees, and reviewed the existing software stack. Ten improvement opportunities emerged. They are ranked in the scorecard in Section 03.

HEADLINE FINDING

We identified an estimated $187,000 in annualized time and revenue opportunity across ten workflows. The top three opportunities account for $104,000 of that total and can be implemented within 60 days for a combined budget of $14,000 to $19,000.

Three patterns drive most of the loss:

- Response gaps. Leasing leads wait an average of 4.7 hours for a first response. After-hours leads wait until the next business day. Industry data puts lead-to-lease conversion at roughly double for responses under five minutes.
- Re-keyed data. Employees enter the same information into the property management system, spreadsheets, and email an average of three times per transaction. Move-ins, work orders, and owner reports all repeat this pattern.
- Memory-driven follow-up. Renewals, delinquency outreach, and vendor follow-up run on individual reminders and inbox discipline. When a coordinator is out, the process stops.

SECTION 02

Workflow Inventory

The recurring processes that consume the most team time, with the friction we observed. Hours are weekly totals across the team, from discovery interviews and system data.

WORKFLOW	OWNER	HRS	FRICTION OBSERVED
Leasing lead response	Leasing (3)	31	Leads from 4 sources land in 2 inboxes and a phone line. First response averages 4.7 hours. No after-hours coverage.
Tour scheduling	Leasing (3)	14	Back-and-forth email and phone tag. Roughly 1 in 5 scheduled tours no-shows with no reminder sequence.
Maintenance intake and routing	Maintenance coord. (2)	26	Residents call or email. Coordinator retypes into the PM system, calls vendors, then updates residents manually.
Work order follow-up	Maintenance coord. (2)	11	Vendor status lives in text messages. Residents call to ask for updates, which interrupts intake.
Renewals	Property managers (4)	9	Spreadsheet tracked. Outreach starts when someone notices a date, often inside 45 days, weakening negotiating position.
Delinquency communication	Accounting (2)	8	Manual notice generation and individual emails. Timing varies by workload, which slows collections.
Resident onboarding	Property managers (4)	10	A 23-step checklist executed by hand: utilities, insurance proof, keys, portal setup. Steps get missed during busy weeks.
Owner reporting	Accounting + PMs	18	Monthly packets assembled from three systems into PDFs by hand. Two to three days of combined effort each month.
Review requests	Nobody (ad hoc)	1	Requests happen when someone remembers. 11 Google reviews in the last 12 months across 38 properties.
Invoice processing	Accounting (2)	12	Vendor invoices arrive by email and paper. Manual entry, manual matching to work orders, manual approval chasing.

Four additional workflows were documented and scored below the opportunity threshold: marketing content, HOA correspondence, inspection scheduling, and payroll administration. They appear in the appendix of a full audit.

SECTION 03

Opportunity Scorecard

Every opportunity scored on impact, implementation cost, effort, risk, and payback. Ranked by expected annualized value. Scores run 1 (low) to 5 (high).

#	OPPORTUNITY	IMPACT	COST	EFFORT	RISK	ANNUAL VALUE	PAYBACK
1	**Automated leasing lead response and routing**	5	2	2	1	$46,000	< 1 month
2	**Maintenance intake, triage, and resident updates**	5	3	3	2	$34,000	2 months
3	**Owner report generation**	4	2	3	1	$24,000	2 months
4	**Self-serve tour scheduling with reminders**	4	1	2	1	$19,000	< 1 month
5	**Renewal pipeline with 90-day triggers**	4	1	2	1	$17,000	< 1 month
6	**Delinquency communication sequence**	3	1	2	2	$14,000	1 month
7	**Invoice capture and matching**	3	2	3	2	$12,000	3 months
8	**Resident onboarding automation**	3	1	2	1	$10,000	2 months
9	**Automated review requests**	3	1	1	1	$7,000	< 1 month
10	**Vendor status portal and notifications**	2	2	3	2	$4,000	4 months

TOTAL IDENTIFIED OPPORTUNITY

$187,000 in estimated annualized time and revenue value. The findings guarantee threshold for this audit is $15,000. Items 1 through 5 are recommended for the first 90 days.

SECTION 04

Time and Financial Estimates

How the top five opportunities convert into hours and dollars. Labor valued at a $31 per hour loaded average for coordinator and leasing roles. Revenue estimates use current portfolio rents and observed conversion rates, held conservative.

OPPORTUNITY	HRS/WK SAVED	ANNUAL LABOR	REVENUE IMPACT	SOFTWARE COST/YR	NET ANNUAL
Leasing lead response	19	$30,600	$18,000	$2,400	$46,000
Maintenance intake	22	$35,500	Included	$1,800	$34,000
Owner reporting	16/mo x 12	$24,700	None	$900	$24,000
Tour scheduling	9	$14,500	$5,400	$600	$19,000
Renewal pipeline	6	$9,700	$8,100	$600	$17,000

Revenue impact notes. Leasing: cutting first response from hours to minutes is modeled to recover 3 additional leases per year at $6,000 average annual rent margin. Tours: reminder sequences are modeled to cut no-shows by half. Renewals: earlier outreach is modeled to lift renewal rate two points, avoiding turn costs.

CAPACITY, NOT LAYOFFS

These numbers assume no headcount reduction. The recovered hours convert into portfolio growth: the current team can absorb roughly 300 additional units at current service levels once the top five items are live.

SECTION 05

Recommended Tools

Selected around the systems Meridian already owns. The property management platform stays. Nothing below requires a data migration. Named products are representative of the category recommended in a real audit; final selection happens with your team.

CATEGORY	APPROACH	EST. COST/MO
Lead response and routing	AI-assisted responder connected to listing sources and the PM system. Answers, qualifies, and books within two minutes, around the clock.	$200
Scheduling	Self-serve tour booking embedded on listings, synced to leasing calendars, with SMS reminder sequences.	$50
Maintenance triage	Structured intake form plus AI triage that classifies urgency, routes to the right vendor, and sends automatic resident status updates.	$150
Reporting	Automated monthly owner packets assembled from the PM system and accounting exports, delivered on a fixed schedule.	$75
Workflow glue	An automation platform connecting the PM system, email, SMS, and spreadsheets for renewals, delinquency, onboarding, and reviews.	$100

Total new software cost at full rollout: roughly $575 per month, or $6,900 per year, against $187,000 in identified value. Every tool above was chosen because it connects to the existing stack through supported integrations, not custom code.

SECTION 06

90-Day Roadmap

The order of operations. Each phase ships something the team uses before the next phase begins.

PHASE	ITEMS	OUTCOME
Days 1 to 30	Leasing lead response (1), tour scheduling (4), review requests (9)	Every lead answered in under two minutes. Tours self-booked with reminders. Review flow running after every move-in and completed work order.
Days 31 to 60	Maintenance intake and triage (2), renewal pipeline (5)	Residents submit structured requests and receive automatic updates. Renewals surface 90 days out with a tracked outreach sequence.
Days 61 to 90	Owner reporting (3), delinquency sequence (6)	Monthly packets generate themselves for review. Notices and reminders send on a fixed cadence.
Quarter two	Invoice capture (7), onboarding automation (8), vendor portal (10)	Accounting and onboarding move from manual to monitored. Evaluated after the first 90 days prove out.

WHY THIS ORDER

Phase one items are low-effort, low-risk, and produce visible wins that fund team buy-in. The maintenance rebuild lands second because it touches residents and vendors and benefits from the momentum. Reporting and collections land third: valuable, but internal, and safe to sequence behind the resident-facing work.

SECTION 07

Implementation Budget Ranges

What it costs to execute this roadmap, whether SMB Automation builds it, your team does, or another provider does. Ranges reflect scope uncertainty that discovery narrows.

SCOPE	RANGE	INCLUDES
Phase one (items 1, 4, 9)	$5,000 to $7,500	Configuration, integrations, testing, training, documentation
Phase two (items 2, 5)	$6,500 to $9,500	Intake build, triage rules, vendor routing, renewal pipeline
Phase three (items 3, 6)	$4,000 to $6,000	Report templates, data connections, communication sequences
Full roadmap	$15,500 to $23,000	All ten opportunities, phased over two quarters

The $1,500 audit fee is credited toward any implementation project of $7,500 or more started within 30 days. There is no obligation: this roadmap is complete enough to execute with your internal team or another provider.

SECTION 08

What Happens Next

A real audit closes with a 60-minute findings presentation where we walk through every section of this document, answer questions, and agree on the order of operations. After that, three paths:

- Implement internally. The roadmap, tool list, and budget ranges are written so your team can execute without us.
- Use another provider. Hand this document to any capable integrator. The scoping work is done.
- Have SMB Automation build it. We implement the roadmap in the phases above, with testing, documentation, training, and a results review at each phase.

THE FINDINGS GUARANTEE

If a Business Efficiency Audit does not identify at least $15,000 in annualized time or revenue opportunity for your business, we refund the full fee and you keep the roadmap.

Ready to see this for your business?

Apply for the audit at smbautomation.io/apply. Applications take about three minutes, and qualified businesses book a fit call immediately.

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